

MSI Raider GE78 HX

Excellent Performance Paired With A Retro Aesthetic

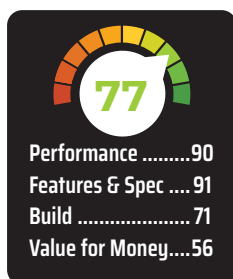
The MSI Raider GE78 HX is the best-performing gaming laptop we tested in 2023, managing to outperform even the earlier iteration of the 2023 MSI GT77 Titan. The latest iteration of the GT77 Titan will most likely outperform the Raider, but not by much considering MSI ships the Raider out with top-of-the-line components as well. We received the top-end model of the MSI Raider GE78 HX, featuring a 13th gen Intel Core i9-13980HX and the NVIDIA RTX 4090 Laptop GPU with a TGP of 175W, the highest allowed configuration from NVIDIA. That is paired with 2 TB of NVMe SSD storage, 64GB of DDR5-5600 RAM, and a 240 Hz, 17-inch QHD IPS display, among other things. The laptop is stacked in the specs department, and we can confidently say that this translates to the performance as well. Let's dive into the review!

BUILD AND DESIGN

Let's start things off with the design. The MSI Raider GE78 HX features a fairly retro aesthetic. The usual sharp edges and accents that we're used to seeing in modern gaming laptops have been replaced with curves and the lightbar at the base of the laptop features "pixel" RGB LEDs. The rear of the laptop features an intricate design for the grill and there's also a red and gold trim running along the back. The overall look is certainly unique enough that the Raider GE78 HX stands out amongst its peers in the market right now. Whether you like the look or not is ultimately up to you.

Costing close to INR 6 lakhs, MSI certainly hasn't skimped out on build quality either. They've improved on

₹4,99,990



the hinges from previous iterations, with the lid now feeling a lot more secure and stable with minimal bounce or flex. There's quite a bit of space between the laptop's lid and base; you can comfortably see through the gap to the other side while the laptop is open.

Considering the specs on board, this is a hefty laptop, weighing in at a little over 3 Kg. The laptop uses lightweight metal alloy for the outer lid and the base, while the bottom panel uses plastic.

The keyboard on the MSI Raider GE78 HX was overall disappointing. We've seen smaller laptops feature keyboards with plenty of space but the keys on the Raider GE78 HX, especially the arrow keys and numpad, feel especially cramped. The RGB lighting on the keyboard and the pixel RGB lighting on the laptop base can be controlled via the SteelSeries GG software. The touchpad is pretty large so there's plenty of room, but the feedback is weak and overall feels unsatisfying; we tend to use a mouse anyway.

I/O PORTS

Coming to the ports, the MSI Raider GE78 HX comes with three USB-C ports,

of which one is a Thunderbolt 4 port. The remaining two come with DP and one of them also has PD charging. Then you have two USB-A ports, an SD card reader, an HDMI 2.1 port, and an RJ45 ethernet port.

DISPLAY

Our variant of the MSI Raider GE78 HX came with a 17-inch QHD IPS display with a refresh rate of 240Hz. During our display testing, we saw an average peak brightness of 406 nits. While not the brightest display we've seen at this price range, it's still plenty bright. Other than that, we tested sRGB coverage of 99.6 percent and a DCI-P3 coverage of 97.5 percent. So the display is colour-accurate as well, and we found the contrast was good too.

THERMALS AND NOISE

Anything with this kind of hardware is going to be loud. When the fans are cranked to their max RPM the Raider can get very loud to the point of drowning out other ambient sounds. We're talking close to 60 dB which is definitely among the loudest we've ever seen in a gaming laptop.

During long gaming sessions, surface temps can get pretty toasty. The centre of the laptop especially where we recorded temps of around 46 degrees. That's uncomfortably hot. The WASD cluster also goes north of 40 degrees so you can certainly feel the heat while gaming. The rest of the laptop remains consistent at around the 31-degree mark. The heat affects performance as well, we did notice throttling during our benchmarks but nothing out of the ordinary. With such laptops, it would be silly not to expect heat.

PERFORMANCE

With that, we come to gaming performance. The MSI Raider GE78 HX had the best benchmark and gaming scores we've seen in a gaming laptop to date. It doesn't come as a surprise considering the 13th gen Intel Core i9-13980HX and the RTX 4090 are the most powerful configuration available on a gaming laptop. That's